

IACOPO GRONCHI

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University College London
Institute for Innovation and Public Purpose
11 Montague Street, WC1B5BP, London, United Kingdom

EMPLOYMENT

UCL INSTITUTE FOR INNOVATION AND PUBLIC PURPOSE

London, UK

PhD candidate in Innovation and Public Policy

2022-current

- Supervisory team: Professor Rainer Kattel; Doctor Kate Roll
- Thesis: "Why missions fail: Rethinking European statecraft in the age of net-zero innovation policy"
- Viva date and outcome: 21 September 2026, minor corrections

DEMOS HELSINKI

Helsinki, FI

Senior expert

2020-current

- Supervisor: Juha Leppänen
- Tasks (selected): content ideation and development; research and project management; workshop design and delivery; direct advice and preparation of notes for high-level clients.
- Clients (selected): Ministry of Economic Affairs of the Finnish Government, FORMAS, Business Finland, Meta Open Loop, Laudes Foundation, Bloomberg Philanthropies, UNDP HQs Strategy & Futures Team.

ITALIAN PARLIAMENT – CHAMBER OF DEPUTIES

Rome, IT

Parliamentary assistant and political consultant

2019

- Supervisor: former '+Europa' MP Alessandro Fusacchia
- Tasks (selected): agenda and project management; political liaising; legal analysis.

INAPP – NATIONAL INSTITUTE FOR PUBLIC POLICY ANALYSIS

Rome, IT

Research assistant

2018

- Supervisor: Professor Dario Guarascio
- Tasks (selected): comparative industrial policy analysis; article drafting.

COPENHAGEN BUSINESS SCHOOL

Copenhagen, DK

Research assistant

2017

- Supervisor: Professor Susana Borrás
- Tasks (selected): research on public sector innovation and collaborative governance.

EDUCATION

SANT'ANNA SCHOOL OF ADVANCED STUDIES

Pisa, IT

Second-level Master's degree in social sciences

2016-2022

- Mark: 100/100 cum laude
- Track: Political science

UNIVERSITY OF FLORENCE

Florence, IT

Master's degree in politics, institutions, and markets

2019-2021

- Mark: 110/110 cum laude
- Thesis: "Rethinking embedded autonomy: A comparative analysis of the implementation of Smart Specialisation Strategies in Tuscany and Emilia Romagna"

UNIVERSITY OF PISA
Bachelor's degree in political sciences

Pisa, IT
2016-2019

- Mark: 110/110
- Thesis: "Public policy and the Fourth Industrial Revolution: A comparative analysis of four European national strategies for technological change and economic growth (IT, UK, FR, DE)"

SKILLS AND ABILITIES

- Language skills: Italian (Native), English (C2), French (B2)
- Software skills: NVivo (Advanced), Atlas.TI (Advanced), R (Intermediate), MS Office tools

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- Research Excellence Scholarship, University College London (£130,000) 2022-2025
- Bartlett Doctoral Conference Funding, University College London (£6,000) 2022-2025
- Academic Rep of the Year Award nomination, University College London 2024
- Student Award Nomination for Excellent personal mentoring, University College London 2023
- Student Award Nomination for Inspiring teaching delivery, University College London 2023
- Nathaniel Lichfield Award for Best Master Thesis, Regional Studies Association (£550) 2022
- Alberto Bardazzi Award for Best Master Thesis, University of Florence (€5,000) 2022
- Barcelona Graduate School of Economics SSPP, UniCredit Foundation (€1,500) 2020
- Allievo Scholarship, Sant'Anna School of Advanced Studies (€50,000) 2016-2021

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

- Gronchi, I. and Entsminger, J. (2026) 'Towards mission theory: A systematic literature review of its critiques and avenues for progress (2010–2025)', *Research Policy*, 55(10), p. 105634. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105634>.
- Gronchi, I. (2026) 'How to craft a mission? A Theory of Action for the strategic public management of mission-oriented innovation policy', *Research Policy*, 55(10), p. 105631. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105631>.
- Gronchi, I. (2026) 'Crafting missions in practice: a formative assessment of public management in European net-zero policy', *Policy Design and Practice*, p. 1–22. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.1080/25741292.2026.2644013>
- Cappellano, F., Gronchi, I., Ingstrup, M. B., Korsgaard, S., and Molica, F. (Accepted / In press) 'Understanding mission management: A multi-focal approach for mission-oriented innovation policy', *Science and Public Policy*.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

POLICY REPORTS (SELECTED)

- Gronchi, I. and Ughi, A. (2026). *Reviewing Italy's industrial policy (2006-2024)*. In (eds.) Di Carlo, D. and Moretti, L. (2026). *LUHNIP Report on Italy's Industrial Policy*. Published by LUISS Hub for New Industrial Policy & Economic Governance, pp. 42-85. Available at this [link](#).
- Kimbell, L. et al. (2025). *Public Design Evidence Review: Literature Review Papers 2-3*. Published by the UK Cabinet Office – Policy Design Community of Practice. Available at this [link](#).
- Gronchi, I. and Mertsola, S. (2023). *Towards experimentalist R&I funding: How research and innovation funders can drive societal transformation in the 21st century*. Published by FORMAS (Swedish Research Council for Sustainable Development). Available at this [link](#).
- Gronchi, I. et al. (2021). *Turning the tide: Landscape analysis of an emergent economic movement in Europe*. Published with the Laudes Foundation. Available at this [link](#).

OPINION PIECES (SELECTED)

- Gronchi, I. (2024). *Viewpoint: EU Missions – Don't throw out the baby with the bath water*. Science Business. Available at this [link](#).
- Gronchi, I. (2023). *Evaluating missions: which is the way forward?* UCL Institute for Innovation and Public Purpose, Medium. Available at this [link](#).
- Gronchi, I. (2022). *Rethinking missions as governance: Transforming government to transform society*. Illuminem. Available at this [link](#)

WORK-IN-PROGRESS MANUSCRIPTS

SINGLE AUTHOR

- Gronchi, I. *Strategizing learning in net-zero mission-oriented policy: A comparative analysis of the Netherlands, France, Denmark, and the UK*.
 - Targeted journal: Public Management Review
- Gronchi, I. *Strategizing accountability in net-zero mission-oriented policy: A comparative analysis of the Netherlands, France, Denmark, and the UK*.
 - Targeted journal: Regulation and Governance
- Gronchi, I. *Strategizing collaboration in net-zero mission-oriented policy: A comparative analysis of the Netherlands, France, Denmark, and the UK*.
 - Targeted journal: Environmental Innovation and Societal Transitions
- Gronchi, I. *Between entrenched technocracy and democratic experimentalism? A comparative institutional analysis of European net-zero innovation policy*.
 - Targeted journal: Environmental Innovation and Societal Transitions, pre-selected for the SI “Governing contested pathways: Industrial policy and sustainability transitions in Europe”

WITH OTHER AUTHORS

- Cova, J. Gronchi, I. and Ughi, A., *Ambition without capacity: Parliamentary politics, policy instruments and the multilevel governance of Italy's industrial policy*.
 - Targeted journal: Politics and Governance, pre-selected for the SI “Goeoeconomic restructuring: Public and private challenges in industrial development, strategy, and governance”

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UCL INSTITUTE FOR INNOVATION AND PUBLIC PURPOSE

Post-graduate teaching assistant

London, UK

2023-2025

- MPA Innovation, Public Policy and Public Value. Modules taught:
 - “Creative bureaucracies” AY2022/2023 (WT), 2023/2024 (WT) (led by Prof. Rainer Kattel)
 - Guest lecturer (2 sessions), 2024/2025 (WT) (led by Prof. Rainer Kattel)
 - “Power, politics, and systems change” AY2024/2025 (FT) (led by Dr. Kate Roll)
- UCL 2023 Student Choice Award in two categories:
 - Nominated for “Excellent personal mentoring”
 - Nominated for “Inspiring teaching delivery”

ADMINISTRATIVE EXPERIENCE

CONFERENCE SESSION CO-ORGANISATION

2026: Eu-SPRI – Special session on the next decade of mission-oriented policy (with Josh Entsminger)

2024: IIPP Annual Forum – Rethinking the State (with Nora Clinton and Bec Chau)

VOLUNTEERING ADMINISTRATIVE WORK

2023-2025: PhD Spokesperson at UCL IIPP; shortlisted for the UCL Academic Rep of the Year Award.
2020-2022: Researcher at CB Lab; NGO helping Italian local administrators improve policy design skills.

POLICY EXPERIENCE

UCL INSTITUTE FOR INNOVATION AND PUBLIC PURPOSE

London, UK
2022-current

PhD candidate

- 6-month fieldwork experience shadowing civil servants at:
 - Dutch Ministry of Climate and Green Growth (KGG). Host: Marjolein Van Splunder
 - Danish National Innovation Fund (AgriFoodTure partnership). Host: Anette Egelund Friis
 - French National Agency for the Ecological Transition (ADEME). Host: Sophie Aubert
 - British National Innovation Agency (Innovate UK). Host: Alexandra Löwe
- 6-month collaboration for data gathering purposes on net-zero innovation policy:
 - OECD Directorate for Science, Technology and Innovation (STI). Host: Philippe Larrue

DEMOS HELSINKI

Helsinki, FI
2020-current

Senior expert

- Selected references:
 - Philanthropies: Hewlett Packard, Bloomberg, Laudes
 - Global level: UNDP (2022-2025 Strategic Plan Evaluation)
 - European level: NetZeroCities platform (EU Mission for 100 Climate-neutral Cities by 2030)
 - National level: Ministry of Economic Affairs of Finnish Government (Mission-oriented policy)
 - Agency level: PD – In-house consulting of the German government (Mission-oriented policy)
 - City level: Camden Council (Mission-oriented policy)

ITALIAN PARLIAMENT

Rome, IT
2019

Parliamentary assistant and political consultant

- Selected references:
 - Inter-parliamentary working group on Artificial Intelligence
 - Public sector innovation and public administration reform

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

2026, 2025, 2024, 2023: Eu-SPRI – European forum of Science Policy for Research & Innovation
2026: SASE – Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics
2025: EGOS – European Group of Organization Studies
2024: EGPA – European Group of Public Administration
2024: EQCA – European QCA Conference Workshops
2023: IPPC – International Public Policy Conference

INVITED SPEAKER

2026, 2024: OECD Mission Forward – International policy conference on mission-oriented governance
2025: University of Utrecht (Host: Matthijs Janssen); Copenhagen Business School
(Host: Susana Borrás); Sciences Po Paris – Institut d'Études Politiques (Host: Charlotte Halpern).
2025: PD (German government's in-house consulting) – Two-day workshop on mission-oriented policy
2024: UCL Mission-oriented Innovation Network – Online session on emerging policy practices
2023: Canada School of Public Service – Online session on creative bureaucracies